AWS Student Builder Group

WAYNE STATE UNIVERSITY

AWS BuilderWars

Hackathon

Join a community of cloud enthusiasts learning, building, and innovating together

FIRST ANNUAL AWS HACKATHON

at Wayne State University

Powered By:

AWS Student Builder Group

Mohammad Altiwainy [Director] maltiwainy229@wayne.edu
Ali Zaidi [Co-Organizer] azaidi@wayne.edu
Mithun Nandhakumar [Co-Organizer] hz0807@wayne.edu

What is the AWS Student Builder Group at WSU?

The AWS Student Builder Group at Wayne State University is a student-led, student-driven organization focused on exploring cloud computing technologies. The organization is dedicated to teaching students about the AWS Cloud and its diverse use cases, covering areas like artificial intelligence, security, business analytics, and business development.

Our Mission? Our goal is to empower WSU students with AWS cloud skills. We strive to create innovation and connect our members directly with industry leaders and opportunities.

What We Do? We aim to provide practical, hands-on experience through AWS cloud projects to develop both technical and business expertise. The club's community of over 250 members participates in several core activities:

- **Workshops & Hackathons:** We organize interactive workshops and hackathons for hands-on learning.
- **Open-Source Projects:** Students can boost their resumes by contributing to real-world, open-source group projects. Active club projects include the AWS Student Hub web platform and other innovative projects.
- **Certification Prep:** We host study groups to prepare for AWS certifications. Members also receive free opportunities to earn these certifications.
- **Networking:** We host networking events to connect our members with experienced industry professionals. We operate an active schedule, hosting a multitude of events each year.

Why Join Us? AWS is the worldwide leader in cloud computing. Gaining these high-demand industry skills provides students with a strong competitive advantage in the modern job market.

Overview of the Hackathon Event

A Hackathon is a competition where teams of students get together to build a software project in a short time frame. At the end, teams present their design philosophy, process, and results to a panel of judges to determine which project wins!
Hackathons are a great way to get in touch with top job-candidates who are passionate about development. They are also an essential step for Computer Science and Electrical & Computer Engineering students towards career readiness.

Your Objective

Your mission is to ideate, design, and build a functional software solution. Over the course of the competition, you and your team will identify a real-world problem, engineer a creative technical solution, and build a working/workable prototype.

Success will require you to balance rapid problem-solving with effective teamwork. Ultimately, your goal is to deliver a compelling final pitch that showcases your project's technical knowledge, user experience, and overall impact to the judges.

Official Hackathon Rules [Please Read Carefully]:

Event Timeline & Deadlines

- **Event Duration:** The event runs from Saturday, November 14th at 10:00 AM to Sunday, November 15th at 4:00 PM.
- **Hacking Window:** All project development must occur strictly during the 24-hour hacking block between **12:00 PM on Saturday and 12:00 PM on Sunday**.
- **Project Submission:** Projects must be fully uploaded and submitted to the event platform (Shipyard) by **12:00 PM on Sunday**. No exceptions will be made for late submissions.

Eligibility Requirements

- **Eligibility:** All participants must be currently enrolled in a College or University. Recent-graduates are also welcomed.
- **Team Size:** Teams must consist of 1 to 4 members.
- **Check-in:** Every member of your team must officially check in at the start of the event.
- **AWS Hackathon Contract: ALL** participants must acknowledge and agree to the AWS BuilderWars Hackathon Code of Conduct prior to participating in the event.
- **Single Entry:** Each team may only submit one final project for the hackathon.

Development & Code Integrity

- **Fresh Code Only:** All elements, code, and assets for your project must be created during the official 24-hour hacking window. Submitting pre-written code from previous hackathons or outside projects is strictly prohibited and violates the AWS Hackathon Code of Conduct.
- **Tools & APIs:** You are fully allowed and encouraged to use frameworks, APIs, cloud services, and anything else that is free and open-source.

- **Video Demo:** Teams must create a <5 minute demo video showcasing their final product and include the link in their final submission.

AI Usage Policy

- **Permitted Tools:** Teams are welcome to use AI assistants during development, including tools for code completion, code generation, and image generation.
- **Transparency Requirement:** Honesty is mandatory. Teams must clearly list any AI tools utilized within their project submission and be prepared to discuss their AI usage transparently with their peers, organizers, and judges.

Community Standards

- **Code of Conduct:** All participants must agree to uphold the MLH Code of Conduct. We are committed to keeping this hackathon a safe, respectful, and welcoming space for everyone.

  *** Failure to do so can lead to possible disqualification**

Event Schedule **IMPORTANT!**

Saturday, November 14

- **10:00 AM - 11:30 AM:** Check-in & Breakfast
- **11:30 AM - 12:00 PM:** Opening Ceremony
- **12:00 PM:** Hacking Officially Begins!
- **12:00 PM - 1:00 PM:** Team Matchmaking

- **1:00 PM - 2:00 PM:** Lunch
- **3:00 PM - 4:00 PM:** Workshop/Speaker Event: *TBD!*
- **5:00 PM - 6:00 PM:** Workshop/Speaker Event: *TBD!*
- **7:00 PM - 8:00 PM:** Workshop/Speaker Event: *TBD!*
- **8:30 PM:** Dinner

Sunday, November 15

- **8:30 AM:** Breakfast
- **11:00 AM - 12:00 PM:** LAST-HOUR for Hacking
- **12:00 PM:** Hacking Ends/Project Submission Deadline
- **12:00 PM - 12:30 PM:** Lunch
- **12:30 PM - 2:30 PM:** Presentations & Judging
- **2:30 PM - 3:00 PM:** Closing Ceremony & Awards

*** Breakfast/Lunch/Dinner will be provided with dietary accommodations**

Themes for the Hackathon Your Choice!

Technology & Emerging Tech

- **Generative AI:** Building intelligent tools and automation.
- **Cloud & DevOps:** Optimizing serverless infrastructure and deployment.
- **Cybersecurity:** Creating data protection and privacy tools.
- **Internet of Things:** Developing connected smart hardware.
- **Web3 & Blockchain:** Building decentralized applications.
- **AR / VR:** Designing immersive spatial experiences.

Industry Solutions

- **FinTech:** Innovating personal and decentralized finance.
- **HealthTech:** Improving wellness tracking and patient care.
- **EdTech:** Enhancing learning and classroom platforms.
- **Logistics:** Optimizing supply chains and tracking.
- **E-Commerce:** Advancing digital retail and shopping.

Tech for Good & Social Impact

- **Sustainability:** Developing eco-friendly and climate solutions.
- **Civic Tech:** Improving smart cities and local government.
- **Accessibility:** Building inclusive tools for disabilities.
- **Disaster Relief:** Creating emergency response systems.

Gaming & Productivity

- **Game Development:** Prototyping and executables for interactive games.
- **Future of Work:** Creating remote collaboration tools.

Open Innovation: No constraints, build whatever you want.

Presentation Guidelines

When it is time to pitch, every team must cover the following five points in their presentation:

1. **The Team:** Introduce your members, your specific roles, and the technical experience you each brought into the weekend.
2. **The Problem:** Clearly define the real-world issue your project is trying to solve.
3. **The Solution:** Describe your application.
    - How does it stand out from what currently exists?
    - Break down your architecture and tech stack (if applicable, highlighting any AWS services you utilized).
    - Explain the core concept simply, as if you are speaking to someone with no background in the project you chose.
4. **The Process:** Share the biggest lessons you learned, the hurdles you overcame, and the specific tools you leveraged during development.
5. **The Product:** Walk the judges and audience through a functional demonstration of your exemplary prototype!

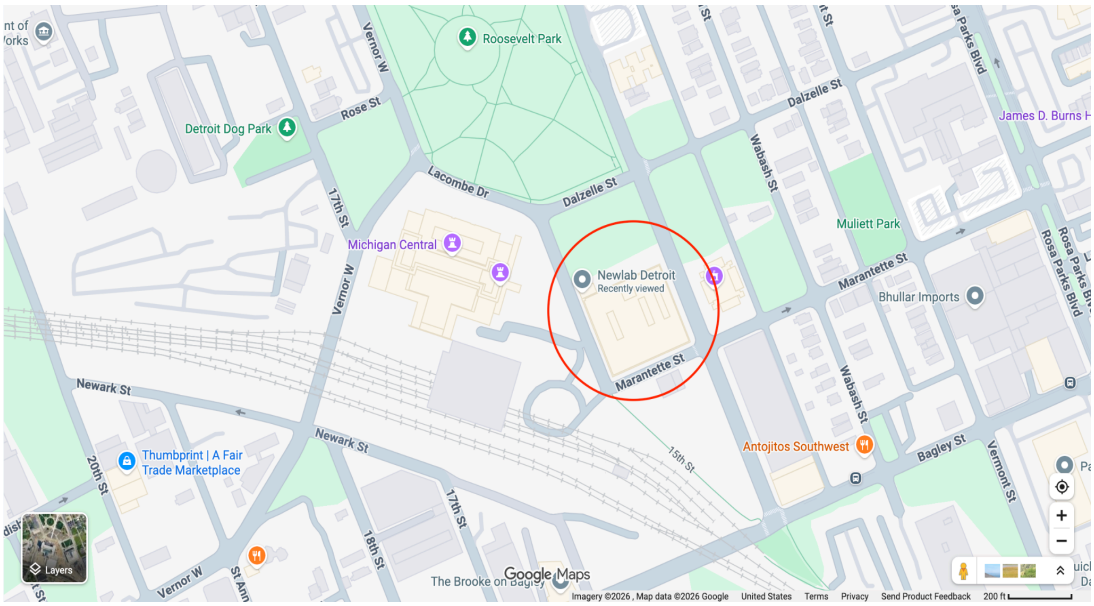
Submission Requirements

To be eligible for judging, teams must complete all of the following steps:

- **Attendance Check-In:** Every team member must officially check in at the venue starting at **10:00 AM on Saturday, November 14**.
- **AWS BuilderWars Code of Conduct:** You **must** acknowledge & agree to this document when registration opens online.
- **Final Submission:** Your final project must be fully uploaded to Shipyard by **12:00 PM on Sunday, November 15**.
- **Video Pitch:** Record a video demo (no more than 5 minutes) of your project and include the link in both your Shipyard submission and your GitHub repository.

Venue & Additional Details:

- Check-in time begins Nov 14th, 2026 10:00AM EST
    - See the schedule for extra info
- Venue is located at 📍 Newlab Detroit
- Will be taking place on the **2nd floor**



Parking:

Parking is available on the nearby streets as well as the [Parking Structure] which is walking distance to NewLab, Detroit.

Street parking is **FREE**, unless there are signs that restrict parking (some areas have a parking time limit)